EUR/USD Expert Advisor Evaluation Checklist

A EUR/USD expert advisor (EA) is the most widely sold automated system in retail forex, and the most widely misrepresented. This checklist is the sequence to run *before* you attach any EUR/USD robot to a live account: prove where the file came from, read the strategy rather than the equity curve, demand five specific numbers, test the backtest for dishonesty, then run a fixed demo period. Print it, or keep it open while you work.

It is a **framework, not a recommendation**. It does not rate any EA and contains no performance figures. Every verdict on this sheet is one you reach from evidence you gathered.

Section A — Prove where the file came from

- [ ] The download comes from a named developer, a broker, or the MQL5 Market (mql5.com) — not a file-sharing host, a Telegram repost, or a renamed copy.
- [ ] You can state the **licence** in one sentence: freeware, open source (MIT/GPL), a demo of a paid product, or a time-limited trial.
- [ ] The **version** and its date are visible, and the changelog explains what changed.
- [ ] If it is open source, you found the repository yourself and the compiled `.ex4`/`.ex5` matches that source release.
- [ ] You know whether it needs a **licence key, account binding, or a DLL** — a DLL is a hard stop on a machine you trade from, because it can reach outside MetaTrader.
- [ ] Nobody has asked you to disable antivirus, run an installer with admin rights, or paste a wallet address to “activate” it.

> **Why this is first.** Almost every reported “EA scam” in retail forex is a provenance failure, not a strategy failure. A file of unknown origin cannot be evaluated at all.

Section B — Read the strategy before you read the curve

A rising equity curve proves nothing on its own. The strategy behind it tells you what will happen the first week the market behaves differently.

- [ ] **Entry logic** — you can describe it in one sentence without the manual (trend, mean-reversion, breakout, session, news).
- [ ] **Exit logic** — fixed take-profit, trailing stop, time-based, or “reverse on the next signal”.
- [ ] **Does it add to a losing position?** Grid, averaging, and martingale all do. Say which one, if any.
- [ ] **Is a stop-loss genuinely used?** A “virtual” stop held in software disappears when the terminal, VPS, or connection drops.
- [ ] **Position size** — fixed, percentage-risk, or multiplied after a loss (see B3).
- [ ] **Filters** — a news filter, a spread filter, a session window, or none.

> **The adding-to-losers question is the one that matters.** A system that multiplies size after a loss has a return profile shaped like a long flat climb with a rare, total loss at the end. It usually looks excellent for months, which is exactly why it sells.

Section C — Demand five numbers

Ask for these five. If any one is missing, treat it as a “no” rather than a maybe — a number that cannot be produced is usually a number that would not help.

Number	What to ask for	Why a missing value is a red flag
Maximum drawdown	The largest peak-to-trough fall, shown separately for *balance* and *equity*.	Balance-only drawdown hides floating losses. Equity drawdown is what closes accounts.
Profit factor	Gross profit ÷ gross loss over the whole tested period — with the trade count.	A profit factor is meaningless without the sample size; ten trades prove nothing.
Trade count & span	How many trades, over how many months, and how many of those were live.	A “ten-year” backtest of 40 trades is closer to an anecdote than a test.
Average trade	Average win, average loss, and the win rate.	A high win rate with a large average loss means one bad day erases many good ones.
Cost assumptions	The spread and commission used in the test.	EUR/USD strategies are spread-sensitive; a test at 0.0 pips is fiction.

Label every figure you are given as one of: a live account result, a forward (demo) test, a backtest, a vendor claim, or a screenshot of unknown origin. They are not interchangeable, and a vendor claim is not evidence.

Section D — Test the backtest for dishonesty

A backtest is a claim about the past that is easy to tune until it fits. These checks separate a test from a sales graphic.

- [ ] **Data and modelling quality.** “Every tick” on real broker data, not “Open prices only”, and a stated modelling quality above 90%.
- [ ] **Spread and commission are modelled.** Many strategies look fine at zero spread and lose at the real EUR/USD spread around the London open and on news.
- [ ] **In-sample vs out-of-sample.** The settings were chosen on one period and then confirmed on a period they were not tuned on.
- [ ] **Walk-forward or rolling tests** exist, rather than one continuous optimised run.
- [ ] **Slippage and execution delay** are recognised — a backtest fills at the requested price; a live order does not.
- [ ] **News periods are included.** A test that quietly skips the first Friday of the month excludes the exact moments most EAs are tested by.
- [ ] **You re-ran it yourself** in your own MetaTrader, on your own broker’s data, and got a broadly similar shape.

> **The one-line test.** Ask what the strategy was optimised on, and what it has since done untouched. If both answers are the same period, the result describes the past, not the method.

Section E — The fixed demo protocol

Fourteen calendar days on a demo account, run identically for every EA you are considering, so the comparison is fair.

- [ ] Same broker and account type you intend to trade live — EUR/USD spreads differ considerably between brokers.
- [ ] Same deposit size you would fund, and the same lot sizing you would use.
- [ ] Same VPS or machine, so latency is constant.
- [ ] AutoTrading on, terminal left running through the session the EA trades.
- [ ] A journal entry per day: trades opened, floating drawdown at its worst, and anything you changed.
- [ ] At the end, compare the demo curve against the backtest over the same dates.
- [ ] Decide before you fund: continue, adjust sizing, or discard it.
- [ ] If you go live, start at the smallest size that still respects the EA’s minimum, and review after a fixed period.

Section F — Position sizing worksheet

Do this once per account so a losing run is survivable by design rather than by hope.

Formula

```
risk per trade (USD) = account equity × risk %
pip value per lot = (pip size × contract size) converted to your account currency
lot size = risk per trade ÷ (stop distance in pips × pip value per lot)
```

Item	Your figure	Example (EUR/USD)
Account equity		$5,000
Risk per trade		1% = $50
Stop distance		20 pips
Pip value, 1.00 standard lot		≈ $10
Lot size = 50 ÷ (20 × 10)		**0.25 lot**

The example is arithmetic, not a target. If the EA cannot trade at the size your risk rule produces, the honest answer is a larger account or a different EA — not a wider stop.

Section G — Red flags

- A claimed win rate above 90% with no drawdown figure anywhere.
- Any wording about certainty of returns, or an “insured”, “capital-protected” or “risk-free” EA.
- Results shown only as cropped screenshots, with no account link, statement, or verified third-party record.
- A different strategy described on every page, or a strategy so vague it cannot be wrong.
- A push to fund immediately, or a price that rises when you hesitate.
- A request for your investor password, or to copy trades onto an account you do not control.
- No way to reach the developer once the sale is complete.

Section H — Go / no-go gate

- [ ] Origin and licence proven (Section A).
- [ ] Strategy understood in plain language (Section B).
- [ ] All five numbers produced, and each labelled by evidence type (Section C).
- [ ] Backtest re-run on my own data with realistic spread (Section D).
- [ ] Fourteen demo days complete, journal written, curve compared (Section E).
- [ ] Sizing fits my risk rule at my account size (Section F).

Any unchecked box is a no-go until it is resolved. That rule is the point of the sheet: it moves the decision from how the curve looks to whether the evidence exists.

EUR/USD Expert Advisor Evaluation Checklist — a free resource from bestmt4ea.com. Free to use, print and share with credit. It is general information, not financial advice, and it rates no product.

Trading forex and CFDs on margin carries a high risk of loss and is not suitable for everyone. Leverage works against you as readily as for you. Historical results, backtests and demo results do not predict future performance. Test any expert advisor on a demo account, with money you can afford to lose, before trading it live.

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